

Off-Page Analysis





What is Off-Page Analysis?



Off-page SEO analysis involves auditing activities outside your website primarily **backlinks**, brand **mentions**, and **reputation** to measure authority and credibility.

It focuses on earning high-quality links and building trust to **improve search rankings**. Key techniques include **backlink auditing**, **competitor analysis**, **guest posting**, and **local citations**.

1. Competitor Analysis





First a few abbreviations:



- **DA: Domain Authority:** DA stands for Domain Authority, a Moz metric predicting a site's ranking potential.
- **DR: Domain Rating:** DR in Ahrefs refers to Domain Rating, a metric measuring the strength of a website's backlink profile on a 0–100 scale

Both are third-party metrics that estimate "authority" and link popularity, calculated differently by their respective platforms.

- **UR (URL Rating):** What it is: URL Rating measures the strength of a specific, individual page's backlink profile.
- **AR (Ahrefs Rank):** What it is: Ahrefs Rank is a global ranking of all websites in the Ahrefs database, sorted by the strength of their backlink profile (DR).



Competitor Analysis



An SEO competitor analysis is where you dig into the SEO strategies of your competitors.

The aim is: to find their **strengths** and **weaknesses** so you can **outrank** them.

Goal:

- Identify the direct competitors in my SEO space
 - Analyze their successful strategies and gaps to inform my seo roadmap
- 



Step By Step Guide: Yala Bena ;)

1- Make a Copy of this [Competitor analysis Report Template](#)

2- **Identify your Goal:** What's the reason the competitor analysis task has been planned? These will help you narrow down the competitor data you find. which will also help you focus only on **relevant keywords**, topics, and **links** to achieve these goals.

3- **Find the direct, meaningful SEO competitors to compare against:**

here's how to identify if their business competitors are also direct SEO competitors.

- **Business competitors:** They sell the same products or services.
- **SEO competitors:** They rank for your target keywords but may have different business models (e.g., bloggers, SaaS tools, local businesses, etc).

→ **If your site has some SEO performance already...**

You can use your existing rankings to find other websites that are targeting the same keywords as you.

To find them, go to Ahrefs Site Explorer > Organic Competitors report.

ahrefs Dashboard AI Content Helper Site Explorer Keywords Explorer Site Audit

http + https ahrefs.com

Overview

Page inspect

Site structure

Calendar

Opportunities

Backlink profile

Backlinks

Broken backlinks

Referring domains

Anchors

Linking authors

Referring IPs

Organic search

Organic keywords

Top pages

Organic competitors

Overview: ahrefs.com/ Ahrefs—Marketing Intelligence Tool

Monthly volume All locations Best links

Backlink profile

DR ⁱ 91

UR ⁱ 57 +2

AR 829 ▲112

Organic search

Keywords ⁱ 386K +150K

Traffic ⁱ 9.3M +6.9M

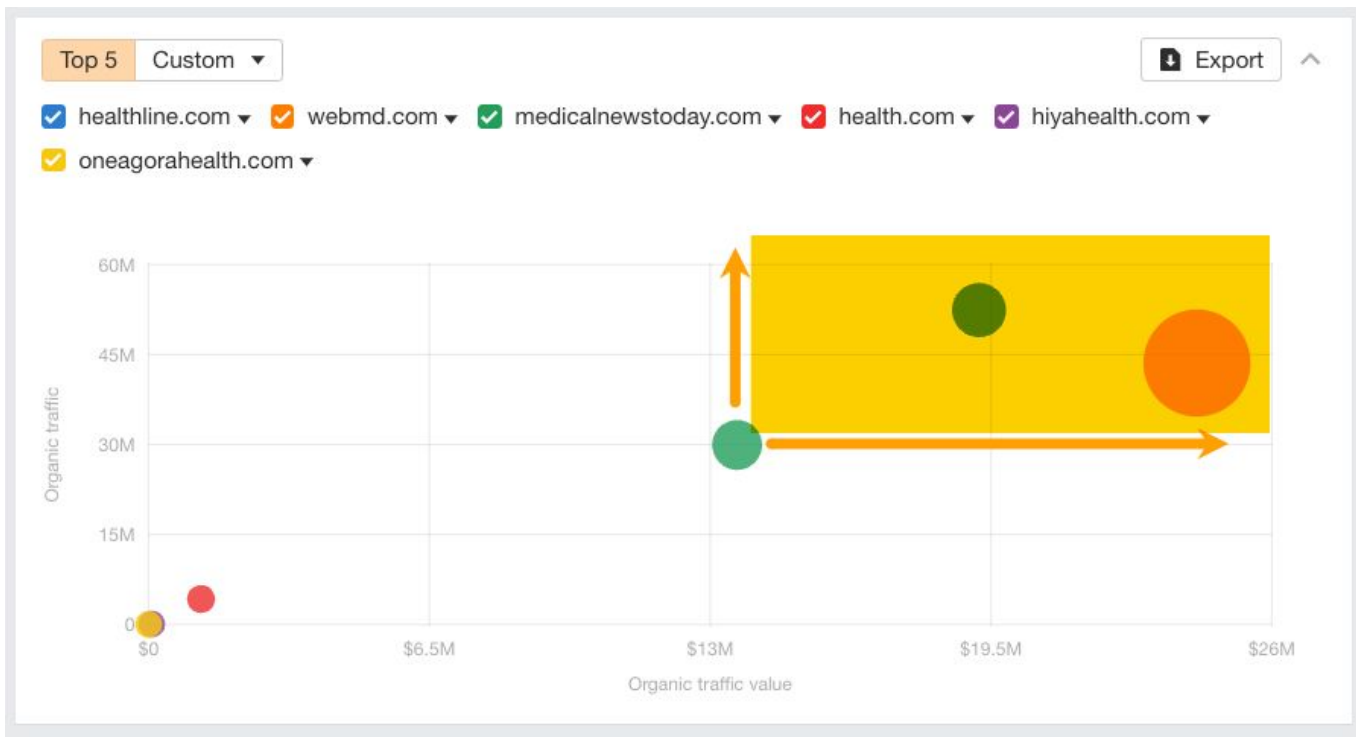
Top 3 27.6K +12.9K

Value \$4.5M +2.2M

General Backlink profile Organic search Paid search

Use the bubble chart to find the competitor bubbles that are:

- Higher than yours (they have **more traffic**)
- Further to the right than yours (their traffic is **worth** more than yours)





Now filter!



By now, you'll have quite a few competitors you could check out. But not all of them are worth analyzing.

For each competitor, decide how you respond to them:

- **Ignore them:** Any competitors that are either not a direct threat, not actively doing SEO (and you can easily beat), or are too authoritative that you can't compete against, ignore them.
- **Join them:** Any SEO competitors that are not business competitors might be worth negotiating a partnership, link exchange, or collaboration with. These are potential untapped opportunities.
- **Beat them:** These are the competitors actively optimizing for your target terms and that are within your ability to outperform over time. Your goal is to outrank them with better content, links, and UX.

Fill the report:

In the report template that you created, **add the competitors you could potentially partner with** as an opportunity in the summary (keep it short here):

Executive Summary

[Keep it concise for decision-makers]

- > Objective
- > Key Insights

Top Opportunities & Threats

Opportunities	Threats
[Major growth area]	[Major risk]
[Another opportunity]	[Another threat]

Also, add the exact name, website, and some notes on each potential partner in the **Market SWOT Analysis section:**

4. Market SWOT Analysis (Trends & Emerging Opportunities)

- > Market Strengths (Growing SEO Factors)
- > Market Weaknesses (Declining SEO Factors)

Market Opportunities (Emerging Trends)

- [List fast-growing areas, competitors, potential industry partners, new features, or emerging trends that competitors are still figuring out.]

Fill the report:

For **the competitors you're going to analyze** in the next steps, add their names in the SEO Scoring Overview:

1. SEO Scoring Overview

Factor	Your Site	Competitor 1	Competitor 2	Competitor 3
Content Performance	★★★★★	★★★★★	★★★★★	★★★★★
Keyword Strategy	★★★★★	★★★★★	★★★★★	★★★★★
Topical Coverage	★★★★★	★★★★★	★★★★★	★★★★★
Brand Strength	★★★★★	★★★★★	★★★★★	★★★★★
E-E-A-T Factors	★★★★★	★★★★★	★★★★★	★★★★★
Backlink Strength	★★★★★	★★★★★	★★★★★	★★★★★
Technical Performance	★★★★★	★★★★★	★★★★★	★★★★★
UX & Core Web Vitals	★★★★★	★★★★★	★★★★★	★★★★★
SERP Features	★★★★★	★★★★★	★★★★★	★★★★★
Notes				

And, also for each section dedicated to **a specific competitor** in the SWOT Analysis:

3. SWOT Analysis for Each Competitor

Competitor 1: [Name]

Strengths:

- [List competitor strengths]

Weaknesses:

- [List competitor weaknesses]



Step By Step Guide:



4- **Analyze how each site gets organic traffic:** Now, it's time to start the analysis. You'll need to analyze **your own site as well as each competitor** you're aiming to outperform with SEO.

- **Your site metrics:** This is the baseline of where you're starting from.
- **Competitor metrics:** These give stakeholders a good overview of **how far ahead competitors are**.

The framework we'll use for each step in the analysis is called SWOT:

Strengths	Assessing what's working well for a site.
Weaknesses	Assessing where a site is underperforming.
Opportunities	Identifying unique competitive advantages or fast-growing tactics a site is leveraging.
Threats	Finding reasons for potential losses in traffic from external sources.



You can input your insights in the respective **sections (Focus, we're looking into sections!!!)** in the template.

For instance, add your site's insights here:

And do the same for each competitor in their dedicated sections in the report.



2. SWOT Analysis for {Your Site / Client's Site}

Traffic Performance

Strengths

- [List key traffic performance strengths]

Weaknesses

- [List key traffic performance weaknesses]

Opportunities

- [List traffic performance opportunities]

Threats

- [List traffic performance threats]

To start the analysis, go to [Ahrefs' Site Explorer > Site Structure](#) and review each site individually. You will see all pages on the website along with their SEO metrics.

For example, we can see that Venngage gets **260,000 estimated monthly** search visits to its template subfolder, which is **9.9% of its total organic traffic**.

Site structure How to use			
Monthly volume ▼ All locations ▼ URL ▼ URL ref. domains ▼ URL organic traf ▼			
14 Jul 2023 ▼ Compare with: 14 Jun 2023 ▼			
Path	Ref. domains	Organic traffic ▼	
venngage.com ▼	22,254	1,516,649	57.6%
> blog ▼	12,990	960,950	36.5%
> templates ▼	3,054	261,044	9.9%
> features ▼	3,027	203,614	7.7%
> gallery ▼	481	31,225	1.2%
> tools ▼	240	2,125	<0.1%
> design-dictionary ▼	43	1,901	<0.1%
> pricing ▼	314	897	<0.1%
> solutions ▼	50	215	<0.1%
education ▼	27	106	<0.1%

If we click one level deeper, we can see the types of templates that send it the most traffic:

From this, it looks like creating brochure and infographic templates was a successful strategy for Venngage.

If Venngage were a competitor, you could list both of these strategies as Strengths in the Competitor Analysis Report.

Path	Ref. domains	Organic traffic ▼	
▼ venngage.com ▼	22,254	1,516,649	57.6%
> blog ▼	12,990	960,950	36.5%
▼ templates ▼	3,054	261,044	9.9%
> brochures ▼	175	29,281	1.1%
> infographics ▼	601	28,301	1.1%
> mind-maps ▼	213	21,799	0.8%
> reports ▼	442	21,631	0.8%
> posters ▼	106	20,462	0.8%
> flyers ▼	148	11,577	0.4%
> presentations ▼	235	9,744	0.4%
> diagrams ▼	301	9,071	0.3%

You could also list Weaknesses too. For example, **Venngage has a fairly weak presence in other international markets:**

If your keyword research indicates that there's enough search demand in these markets, and it's in alignment with your brand's goals, then:

- You could list this as a weakness for Venngage
- You could also list it as an opportunity for your site
- Or, if **all of your competitors** have this as a weakness, then list it as a market opportunity

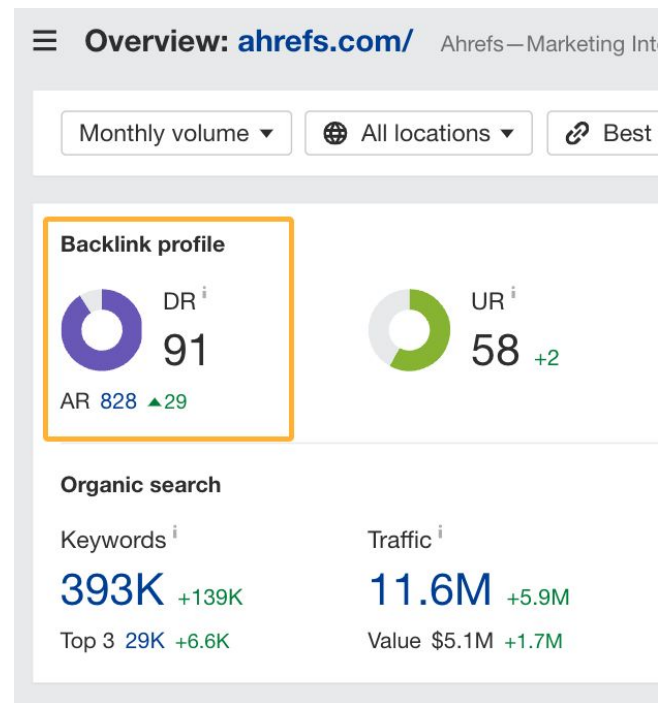
Path	Organic traffic ▼	Change	Traffic value
>  venngage.com ▼	681,406	57.5% 	\$340.5K
>  es.venngage.com ▼	402,396	33.9% 	\$29.8K
>  pt.venngage.com ▼	71,403	6.0% 	\$8.2K
>  ar.venngage.com ▼	7,886	0.7% 	\$448
>  fr.venngage.com ▼	7,387	0.6% 	\$2.7K
>  de.venngage.com ▼	7,210	0.6% 	\$3.4K
>  it.venngage.com ▼	5,449	0.5% 	\$1.1K

Step By Step Guide:

5- Check each site's brand strength and authority:

In Site Explorer, there are a few different ways to assess a website's brand strength and authority.

The first is the Domain Rating metric: This metric indicates how strong a website's backlink profile is. It factors in both the quality and quantity of links and referring domains.



→ Manually assessing E-E-A-T elements

Another critical aspect of a brand is how it displays E-E-A-T elements:

- **Experience - Expertise - Authoritativeness - Trustworthiness**

Take a manual look at each website and look at how trustworthy the website feels. You can also assess specific features like:

- Is there an About page?
- Is it clear who owns the business and website?
- Are there dedicated pages for each prominent staff member or business leader?
- Are there prominent contact details in the footer and the contact page?
- Is it easy to contact the business?
- Are there essential legal pages like Privacy, Disclaimers, Terms + Conditions?
- Are there reviews from third-party sites like FaceBook or Google Business?

Ultimately, E-E-A-T is subjective. There's no quantitative score you can get from a tool, but you can record strengths and weaknesses as you explore each site.

If all of your competitors are missing opportunities to enhance the trustworthiness and E-E-A-T signals on their sites, this could be a major opportunity for you to capitalize on.

Step By Step Guide:

6- Check out the keyword strategy for each site to get top-performing topics:

There are two ways you can investigate a site's keyword strategy:

- Compare it to your own and find the gaps
- Analyze each site individually to find its top-performing opportunities

Start by using Ahref's [content gap analysis process](#) to find keywords your competitors rank for that you don't.

- [Full process to follow](#)
- [Template to copy](#)

Competitive Analysis

Analyze competitors' websites compared to yours.

Show

keywords

referring domains

referring pages

This target doesn't rank for

healthline.com

Subdomains ▼

But these competitors do

webmd.com

Subdomains ▼

medicalnewstoday.com

Subdomains ▼

health.com

Subdomains ▼

+ Competitor

Show keyword opportunities

→ Comparing competitors side-by-side...

Keyword	You rank better	Competitors rank better	Keyword Notes
Keyword 1	Yes	No	Your strength, their weakness
Keyword 2	No	Yes	Their strength, your weakness

→ Doing a deep dive into each competitor...

☐ Keyword	Volume	KD	CPC	Traffic
☐ ✓ paragraph rewriter	38.0K	14	0.06	40,617
☐ ✓ sentence rewriter	51.0K	12	0.03	38,583
☐ ✓ ai humanizer	168.0K	46	0.67	24,662
☐ ✓ humanize ai	253.0K	34	0.47	23,722
☐ ✓ rewording tool	71.0K	39	0.04	18,126

Step By Step Guide:

7- Do a page-by-page content analysis: In Site Explorer > Top Pages, you can find each of the top-performing posts and pages for any website.

For each site in your analysis, review the best-performing content formats like:

- Service pages
- How-to posts
- Templates
- Ultimate guides
- Listicles
- Product reviews
- And so on ...

20,785 pages

Total traffic: 674.4K

📅

12 Feb 2025

▼

Compare with: 13 Oct 2024

▼

📄

Export

URL	Status	Traffic	Change	Value	Change	Keywords
https://venngage.com/templates ▼		41,174 6.1%		\$15.3K		34,188 ▼
https://venngage.com/blog/what-is-an-infographic/ ▼		40,892 6.1%		\$13.9K		25,277 ▼
https://venngage.com/blog/business-proposal/ ▼		32,829 4.9%		\$13.1K		8,076 ▼
https://venngage.com/ ▼		21,806 3.2%		\$10.5K		7,749 ▼
https://venngage.com/features/poster-maker ▼		19,208 2.8%		\$4.2K		4,886 ▼
https://venngage.com/ai-tools/poster-generator ▼		14,370 2.1%		\$1.8K		3,962 ▼

Step By Step Guide:

You can also do a deep dive on any pages you'd like more SEO data on.

Click the little down arrow next to that page and then check out the Overview report.

If you have content that's similar to your competitor's top content **but it's not ranking**, here's what you can check:

- The links to your page vs competitors
- Each page's URL rating (Ahrefs' page authority metric)
- On-page signals like page titles, descriptions, headings
- Content structure and keyword inclusions
- Topical depth issues
- Thin or low-quality content
- Lack of originality or poorly written content
- Conversion potential, like calls to action
- URL structure or informational architecture

https://venngage.com/ganizer-examples/ ▼	AR 4,957	DR 85	UR 6
https://venngage.com/phic-maker ▼	Site Explorer		
https://venngage.com/-vs-histograms/ ▼	Overview		
https://venngage.com/y-tree-software/ ▼	ORGANIC & PAID		
https://venngage.com/n/ ▼	Organic traffic		41
https://venngage.com/us-key/ ▼	Traffic value		\$24
https://venngage.com/ume-examples/ ▼	Organic keywords		366
	Paid keywords		0
	BACKLINK PROFILE		
	Referring domains		5
	Backlinks		7
	View on Archive.org		↗
	Inspect		🔍

Step By Step Guide:

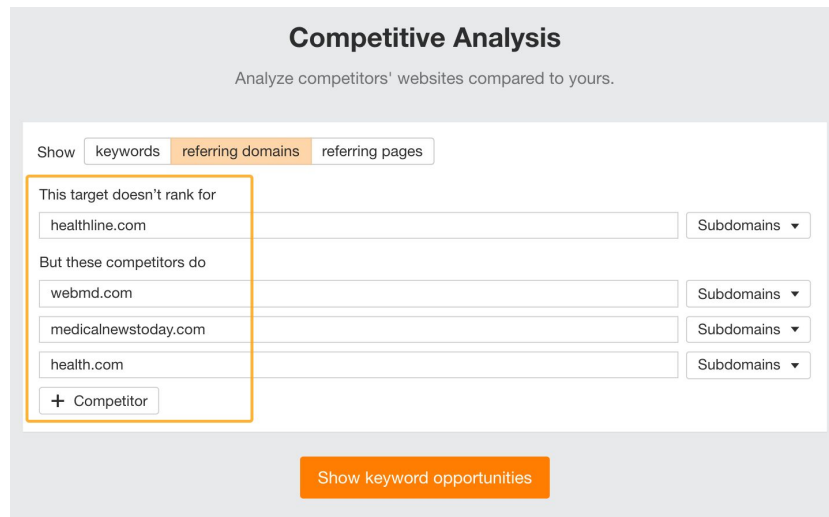
8- Analyze each site's best links and which authors they come from:

As with the previous step, you can analyze a website's backlink strategy by:

- Comparing it to your own site and finding the gaps
- Analyzing each site individually to find the best opportunities

Steps:

1. Open Ahrefs' Competitive Analysis tool and set it to "referring domains"
2. Where it says "the target doesn't rank for", add your website. Beneath that, add your list of competitors:



The screenshot shows the Ahrefs Competitive Analysis tool interface. At the top, the title "Competitive Analysis" is displayed, followed by the subtitle "Analyze competitors' websites compared to yours." Below this, there are three tabs: "keywords", "referring domains" (which is selected and highlighted in orange), and "referring pages". The main content area is divided into two sections. The first section, "This target doesn't rank for", contains a text input field with "healthline.com" and a "Subdomains" dropdown menu. The second section, "But these competitors do", contains a list of competitor websites: "webmd.com", "medicalnewstoday.com", and "health.com", each with its own "Subdomains" dropdown menu. Below the competitor list is a "+ Competitor" button. At the bottom right of the interface is an orange button labeled "Show keyword opportunities".

Analyze each domain's relevance

Open the website to see what it's about. If it is:

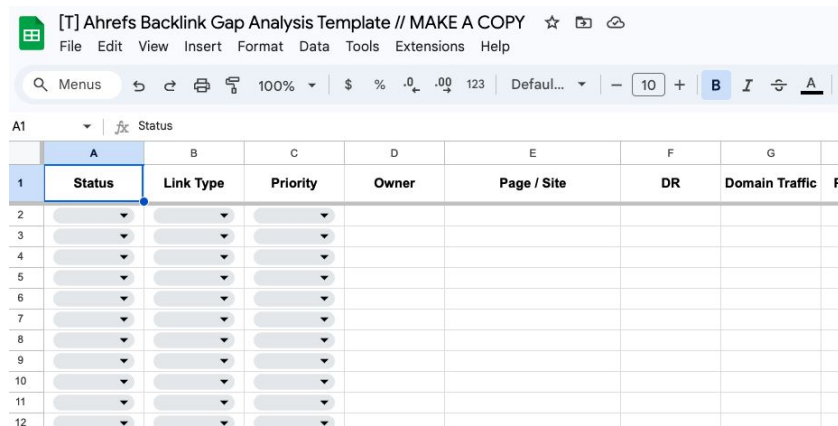
- Not about your industry
- Not a business directory
- Not a high-quality site that can build your brand

... do not add it to your prospecting list. Move on to the next domain and repeat this assessment process.

For each website you identify that's relevant, and you can likely get a link from it, add it to your copy of the template.

Focus on filling out the columns for:

- **Page / Site:** Add the domain here.
- **Domain Rating (DR):** Add the domain's authority score.
- **Domain Traffic:** Add the traffic across the entire website.



[T] Ahrefs Backlink Gap Analysis Template // MAKE A COPY

File Edit View Insert Format Data Tools Extensions Help

Search Menus 100% 123 Default... 10 B I A

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H
1	Status	Link Type	Priority	Owner	Page / Site	DR	Domain Traffic	P
2								
3								
4								
5								
6								
7								
8								
9								
10								
11								
12								



Site Explorer Demo from Ahrefs





Competitor Analysis SE Ranking

Login → Project → Added Competitors

Login → Project → SERPs Competitors (Shows Ranking for specific Keywords)





MOZ.Com

Free SEO Tools → Competitive Research (Only in USA & Canada)



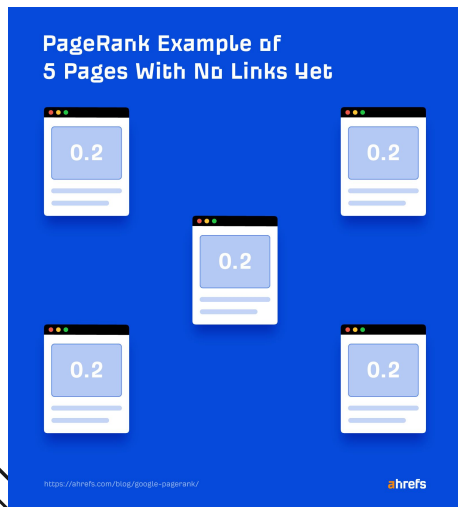
Link Building



What is Backlinking?

You can think of links as votes. When other websites are linking to your page, it tells Google that your page is somehow important. Which is essentially [Google's PageRank algorithm](#) in a nutshell.

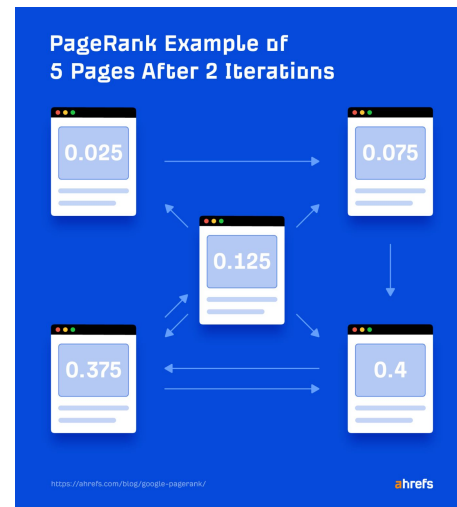
Five pages with no links. Each gets a PageRank of $(1/5)$ or 0.2.



If I add some links to the five pages above and calculate the new PageRank



It's the same pages with the same links, but the base PageRank for each page has changed, so the resulting PageRank is different.





The Base PageRank

The base PageRank algorithm, developed by Google founders Larry Page and Sergey Brin, calculates a webpage's **importance** by treating incoming links as "**votes**".

It assigns a score based on the quantity and quality of these links, where links from high-importance pages pass more weight.

Then, PageRank is passed between pages through links, The final PageRank depends on:

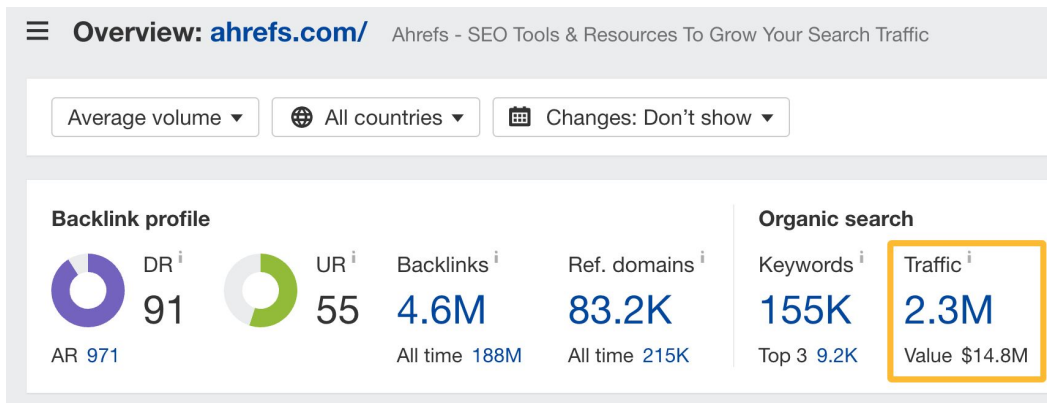
- how many links a page gets
- the quality of those links
- how PageRank flows across the network



Before: What are the evaluation criteria?

- **Relevance:** We need links from a site with high topical relevance.
- **Domain Rating:** The DR of a website is a good indicator of how strong its backlink profile is, as well as how much link equity can be passed to your site.
- **Organic traffic:** How much organic traffic a website gets each month?

You can check these metrics of any site by plugging it into Ahrefs' **Site Explorer** to get a quick overview.





How to build links

Conceptually, most popular link building strategies fall into one of the following four buckets:

1. **Adding links:** That's when you go to some website and manually add your link there.
 2. **Asking for links:** That's when you send emails to owners of relevant websites and ask them to link to you.
 3. **Buying links:** Same as above, but you offer them money (or some other form of compensation).
 4. **Earning links:** This refers to creating and promoting something so noteworthy that people would link to it naturally.
- 



Adding Links

This is when you go to a website that doesn't belong to you and **manually** place your link there.

The most common tactics that fit into this category are:

- Social profiles creation.
- Business directory submissions.
- Review site listings.
- Posting to forums, communities, and Q&A sites.

Some professional link builders prefer to **start** with these kinds of links when they're working with a brand-new website.

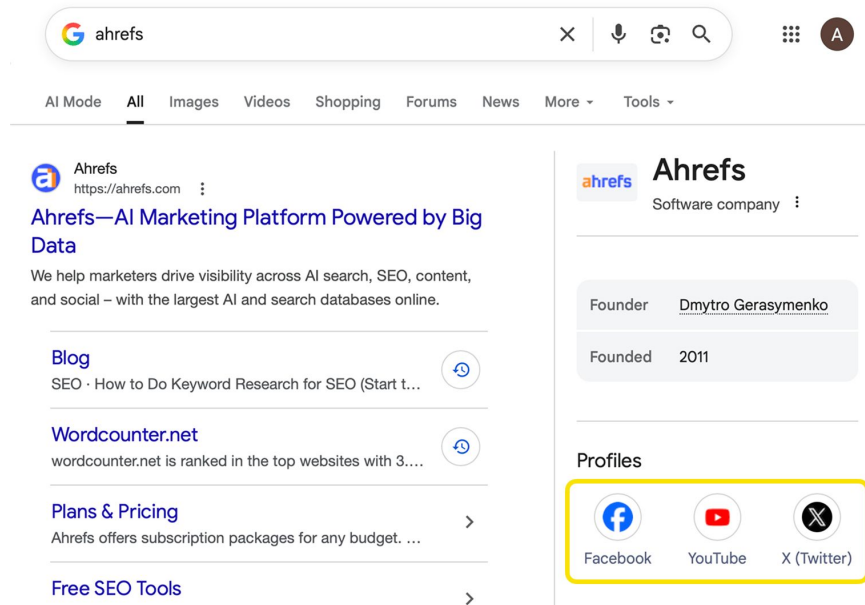
They refer to it as building "**foundational links**."



Google clearly pays attention to these profile pages. Look at the "**Knowledge**" panel for **Ahrefs** (see the screenshot below), you'll notice the links to Ahrefs **social profiles featured there**.

And Ahrefs weren't the ones who added them (as per their case study).

Google **identified** their social profiles on its own and **linked** them to the Ahrefs brand as part of its Knowledge Graph.



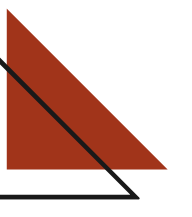


It's Very easy and your competitors are doing it as well.

Yes, these kinds of links are either **nofollow** or **very, very weak**. Which means that they **hardly move the needle** when it comes to ranking in Google.

But there's a chance that over time your profile pages will accrue some quality links of their own.

For example, **Ahrefs' profile page on Twitter** **got 11,000 backlinks**, coming from over **a thousand different websites**. So I'm pretty sure it does have some "weight" in the eyes of Google.





Asking for Links



This is when you reach out to other website owners and ask them for a link, which SEOs often refer to as ”**link outreach.**”

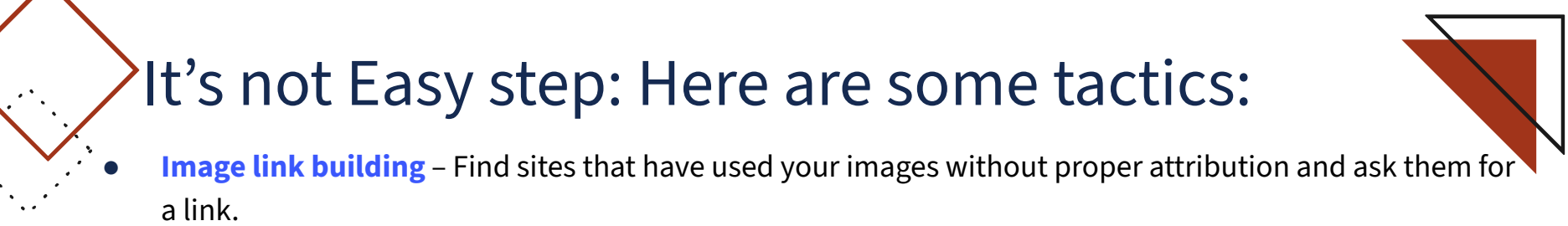
You need to pick websites that are somehow **related** to your page, since they are more likely to actually consider your request → This is called Link **Prospecting**

Link Prospecting: Link prospecting is the process of finding and evaluating potential sites to acquire links from.



It's not Easy step: Here are some tactics:

- **Guest posting** – Write an awesome article for their website, from which you can link to yourself.
- **Skyscraper technique** – Find an outdated (or somehow inferior) page that lots of websites are linking to. Create a much better one on your own website. Then show it to all the “linkers.”
- **Resource page link building** – Find pages that list resources similar to yours and request to be added there.
- **Broken link building** – Find a dead page that has lots of links. Create an alternative on your own website and ping all the linkers about it. That's broken link building in a nutshell.



It's not Easy step: Here are some tactics:

- **Image link building** – Find sites that have used your images without proper attribution and ask them for a link.
- **HARO** (Help A Reporter Out) **and journalist requests** – Keep an eye on their call outs and Contribute an “expert quote” for journals article.

It is the process of responding to journalist queries on the [Connectively platform](#) (formerly HARO) to gain high-quality, authoritative backlinks and media mentions.

- **Unlinked mentions** – Ask to turn the mention of your brand into a link.
 - **[Google Alerts](#)**: Set up alerts for your brand name and key products to get notified of new mentions in real-time.
 - **Search Operators**: Search Google for "[Your Brand]" -site:yourwebsite.com to find mentions on external sites.
 - **Specialized Tools**: Utilize tools like SEMrush Brand Monitoring, Ahrefs Content Explorer, or BuzzStream to track mentions.
- **PR** – Give them a killer story to cover.



Buying Links

This is the easiest way to build links. A lot of website owners would be happy to link to you if you pay them for it.

But exchanging money (or anything else, really) for links is quite risky. [Google considers it a manipulation of its algorithm](#). And it might punish you for it by kicking your website out of the search results.

Another risk of buying links comes from simply wasting your money on [bad links](#) that won't even work in the first place.

So, Nothing to be taught here!





Earning Links

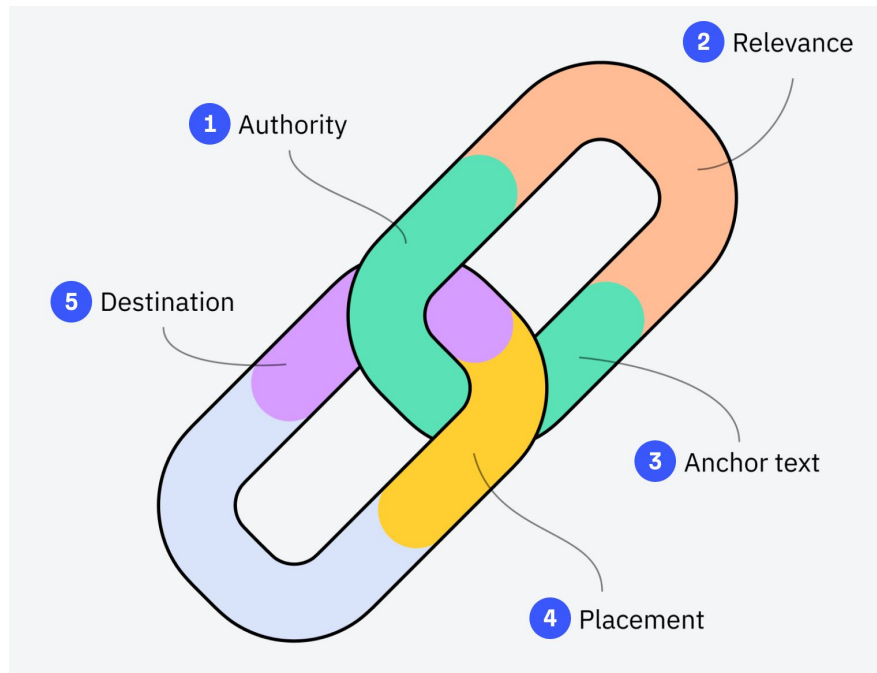
You "earn" links when other people link to the pages on your website without you having to ask them to do so.

This won't happen unless you have something **truly noteworthy** that other website owners will genuinely want to mention on their websites.

1. Your company's proprietary data: Ahrefs case study (In 2017, Ahrefs used their proprietary data to carry out a unique research study, which answered one of SEO's most frequently asked questions: "[How long does it take to rank in Google?](#)" As of today, this blog post has almost 3,000 backlinks from about 1,700 different websites)
 2. Results of experiments (which require significant efforts)
 3. Unique ideas and strong opinions (i.e., thought leadership)
 4. Industry surveys
 5. Breaking news
- 

Which links make a difference?

- Different kinds of links have different impacts on your page's ranking in Google. And no one knows for sure how exactly Google measures the value of each individual link.
- But there are **five general concepts** of evaluating links that the SEO community believes to be true.



1- Authority

- URL Authority (**Ahrefs & Moz**): links from more well-known and authoritative websites have a bigger influence on your page's rankings in Google.

Ahrefs FREE Web Authority Checker → [Link](#)

apple.com



Domain Rating ⁱ

97



URL Rating ⁱ

Get UR free with
[Ahrefs SEO](#)
Toolbar

Backlinks ⁱ

6.8B

90% dofollow

[Top 100 backlinks](#)

Linking websites ⁱ

4.3M

94% dofollow

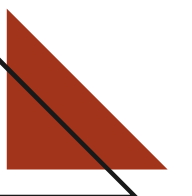


2- Relevance

If you run a blog about **health and fitness**, links from other websites (and pages) on the **same topic** will have **more weight** in the eyes of Google compared to links from websites about cars or finances.

3-Anchor

“anchor text” is a clickable **snippet of text** that links to another page. In many cases, it describes what the linked page is about.



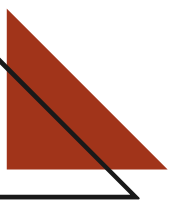


4- Placement

Where in the page is your URL? It's place affects the CTR.

How high on the page the URL appears. Readers are more likely to click the links at the very beginning of the article rather than the ones at its very end.

5- Destination

- Your homepage.
 - Your linkable assets: (Pdf, Infographic, Case study, Research, etc ...)
 - The actual pages that you need to rank well in Google (usually called "money pages").
- 

SEO STrategy



Key Components of SEO Strategy

- **Keyword Research** → what users are searching for
- **Content Creation** → valuable, relevant content
- **On-Page SEO** → titles, meta descriptions, structure
- **Technical SEO** → site speed, mobile-friendliness
- **Link Building** → backlinks from other websites
- **Measuring SEO Success** → Track: organic traffic
keyword rankings conversions

Keyword Research

- Identify terms your audience uses
- Focus on:
 - search volume
 - competition
 - Relevance
- Helps guide content topics

Technical SEO

- Improve website performance:
 - fast loading speed
 - mobile-friendly design
 - proper indexing
- Helps search engines crawl and rank your site

Link Building

- Get links from trusted website
- Signals authority to search engines
- Improves rankings and credibility

SEO Goals

Defining goal:

- Give clear direction to SEO strategy,
- Help teams stay aligned on priorities,
- Allow you to measure progress and success,
- Improve decision-making and resource allocation

Goals must be **clear and detailed**

- Avoid vague goals like: “Increase traffic”
- Instead use: “Increase organic traffic by 20% in 3 months”

Steps to Set **SMART** SEO Goals:

- Start with current performance (benchmark)
- Define clear objectives
- Choose measurable KPIs
- Ensure goals are realistic
- Align with business strategy
- Set a timeline for execution

Actionable SEO Goal Examples:

- Increase Organic Traffic
- Improve Keyword Rankings
- Enhance Conversion Rates for specific landing pages
- Boost Visibility/increase organic CTR
- Build Authority

What Types of SEO Services Can You Get?

Which SEO services could your site benefit from? And what does that look like? Here are a few popular SEO services that you might want to consider. Notice how they overlap.

On-Page SEO

- ✓ User experience
- ✓ Content strategy
- ✓ Content production
- ✓ Keyword strategy
- ✓ Content audit
- ✓ Web design

Off-Page SEO

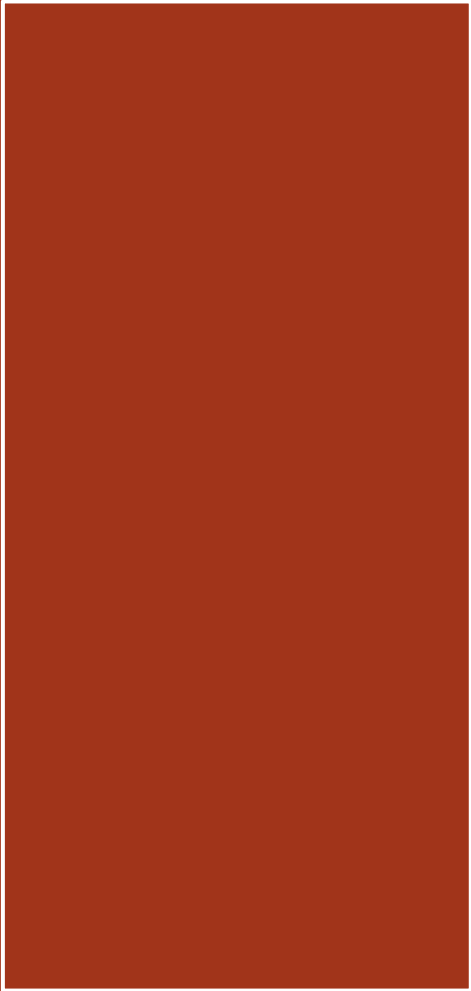
- ✓ Link building
- ✓ Off-site content strategy
- ✓ Off-site content production
- ✓ Backlink audit
- ✓ Social media marketing
- ✓ Online reputation management
- ✓ Digital PR

Technical SEO

- ✓ User experience
- ✓ Technical SEO audit
- ✓ Mobile SEO audit
- ✓ Optimizing code and file sizes
- ✓ Site migration
- ✓ Web design
- ✓ Site security

Local SEO

- ✓ Online citation management
- ✓ Google Business Profile
- ✓ Local keyword strategy
- ✓ Local PR and link building



AI Search Optimization

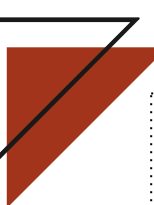




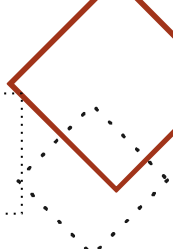
AI Search Optimization

AI is transforming search behavior. Instead of short keywords, users now ask full questions and even follow-up questions, similar to a conversation. This means search is becoming more interactive, and content needs to adapt to this shift.

- **GEO (Generative Engine Optimization)** (The "New SEO"): Focuses on being cited as a source by AI engines like Perplexity or Google's AI Overviews. It requires deep, trustworthy content that AI can summarize.
 - **AEO (Answer Engine Optimization)**: “Zero Click Search” “User doesn’t need to click” Focuses on providing concise answers, often in FAQ formats, to own the "People Also Ask" or voice search result spots.
 - **LLMO (Large Language Model Optimization)**: Focuses on **brand authority** within **large models** (e.g., Claude), ensuring the AI understands, trusts, and correctly recommends a brand.
- 



Key Differences and Goals

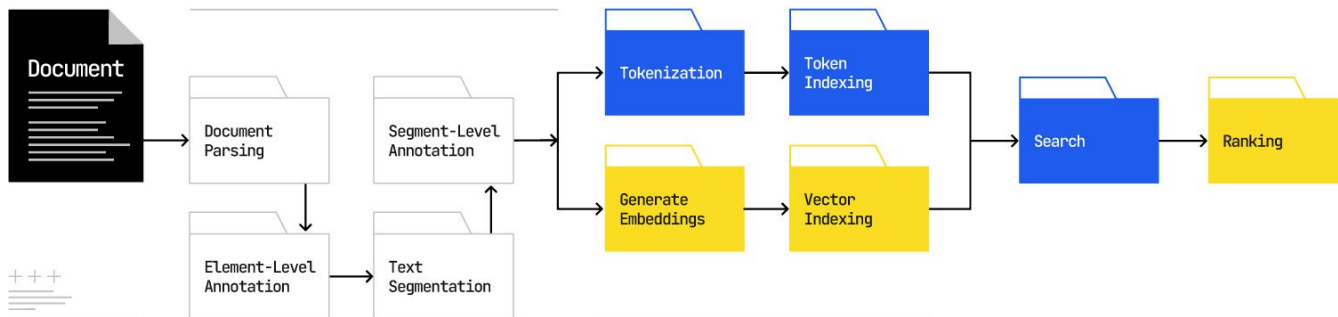


- **GEO** is about building authority to be cited as a source in longer AI-generated reports.
- **AEO** is about formatting for quick answers (e.g., "What is...").
- **LLMO** is about entity recognition, ensuring the model understands who you are and what you do.

Visibility is No Longer Just Rankings

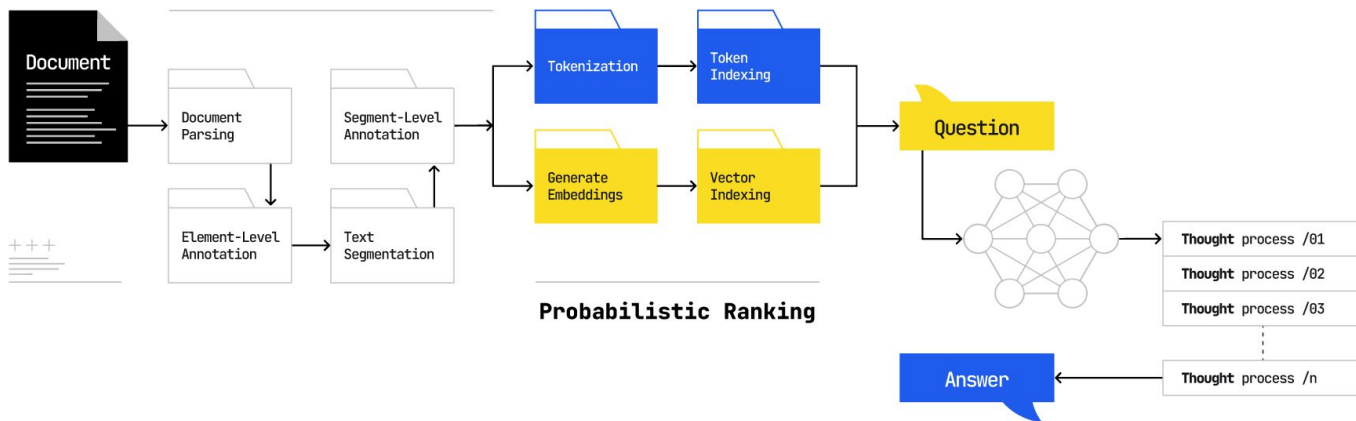
In traditional SEO, ranking on page 1 was the goal. Now, AI tools like Copilot select specific pieces of content to show in answers. So even if your page ranks, it may not appear unless your content is structured for AI





Deterministic Ranking

How AI Mode Works?



Probabilistic Ranking

Diagram 1: Deterministic (حتمية) Ranking (Traditional Search)

- **1- Document Processing** The document is analyzed:
 - parsing (reading structure)
 - breaking into parts (segmentation)
 - adding annotations (labels/metadata)
- **2- Token-Based Processing (Blue path)**
 - Text is split into **tokens (words/keywords)**
 - Tokens are stored in an index (Token Indexing)
- **3- Vector-Based Processing (Yellow path)**
 - Text is converted into **embeddings (numerical meaning)**
 - Stored in a vector database
- **4- Search**
 - When a user searches, the system retrieves matching content
- **5- Ranking**
 - Results are ranked using **fixed rules/algorithms**

Diagram 2: Probabilistic (احتمالية) Ranking (AI / LLM Search)

- **1 - Documenting + 2- Token + 3- Vector Are the Same**
- **4- User Question**
 - Instead of just keywords, user asks a **full question**
- **5- Neural Network (AI Model)**
 - The system doesn't just retrieve results
 - It **interprets (يترجم) and reasons**
- **6- Thought Process (multi-step reasoning)** The model:
 - analyzes context
 - connects ideas
 - generates intermediate steps
- **7- Final Answer**
 - Instead of links → you get a **generated answer**



How AI Works & Answer?

Instead of ranking pages like traditional SEO, AI Mode:

1- **Understands the query deeply**, Not just keywords. It looks at intent, context, and meaning

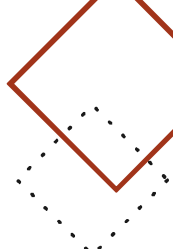
2- **Pulls content from multiple sources**: Websites, Videos, Podcasts and Images

It doesn't rely on one page - it combines many sources

3- **Breaks the query into smaller parts**: AI creates **multiple sub-questions** (query expansion) then Finds answers for each part and Finally merges them into one response

4- **Synthesizes (builds) a final answer**: It Extracts → facts, quotes, data points. Then Combines them into: summaries, lists, explanations. So, the result is new content generated by AI, not just links



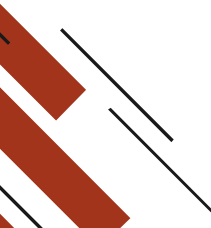


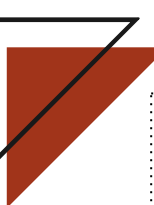
What marketers should do (from the page)

Marketers should:

- Optimize content for answers, not just keywords
- Build authority & credibility
- Create clear, structured content

“If AI crawlers can’t read your content, you don’t exist in AI search.”





Content is the Most Important Factor

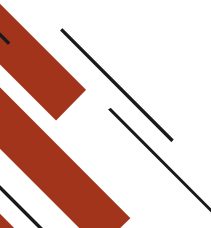
AI systems prioritize content that is trustworthy and easy to understand. If your content is unclear or outdated, it won't be selected even if it's optimized for SEO. So, Your content should be:

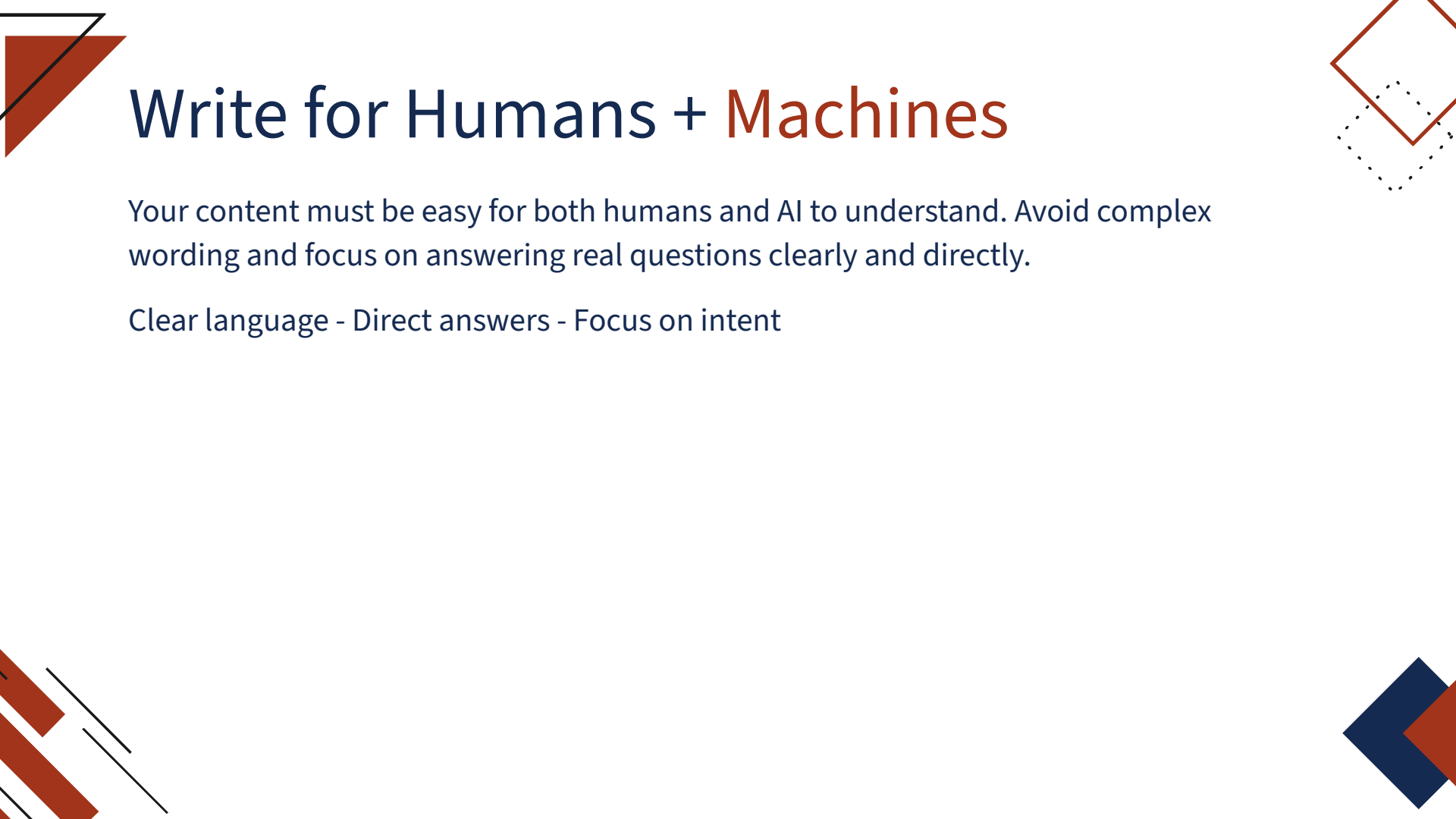
Clear - High-quality - Up-to-date - Authoritative

Structure Your Content for AI

AI doesn't just read content it breaks it into smaller parts (called parsing). Well-structured content makes it easier for AI to extract and use your information in answers.

Use headings (H1, H2, H3) - Break content into sections - Use lists and clear formatting





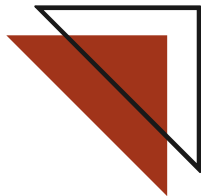
Write for Humans + Machines

Your content must be easy for both humans and AI to understand. Avoid complex wording and focus on answering real questions clearly and directly.

Clear language - Direct answers - Focus on intent



AI Search Landscape Complete Academy of Reports & Guides



For you:

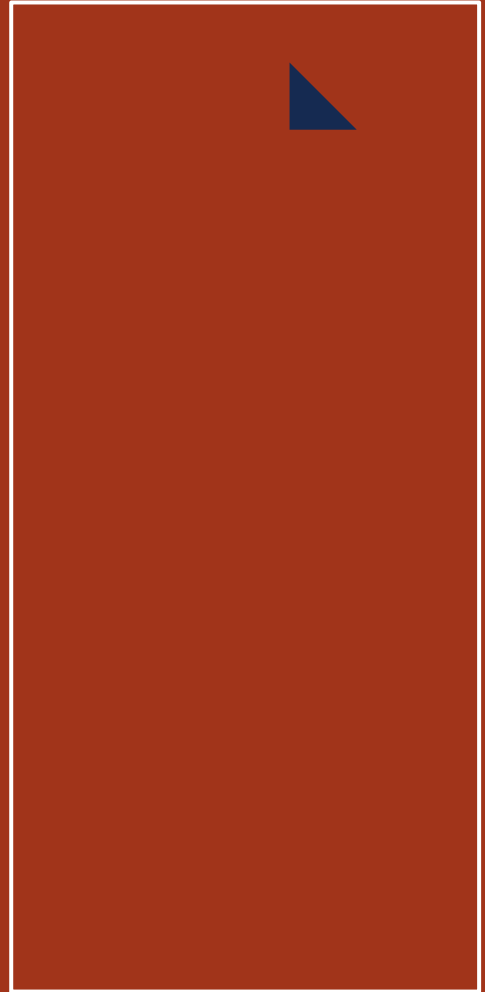
E-commerce SEO: Starts here: <https://ahrefs.com/blog/ecommerce-seo/>

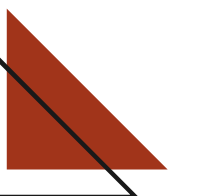
E-Commerce Optimization:

<https://www.aleydasolis.com/en/search-engine-optimization/optimizing-content-in-category-pages-while-keeping-its-commercial-nature/>



Self Study/References



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 - <https://developers.google.com/search/docs/essentials>
 - <https://blog.hubspot.com/marketing/technical-seo-guide>
 - <https://ahrefs.com/blog/keyword-research/>
 - <https://ahrefs.com/blog/content-optimization/>
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 - <https://ahrefs.com/seo/link-building>
 - https://learningaisearch.com/ai_roadmap/optimize-ai-search/ai-search-landscape/
- 



Thanks!

Do you have any questions?

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